

98, I can easily use this card (the soundcard uses the IRQ 10). But I can't even install the soundcard when I switch over to Windows 2000. When I insert the installation CD for the Creative soundcard for Windows 2000, I get a message, 'Setup could not find any Creative soundcard on the system. Setup will exit now'. Why is this happening?

Tamal Saha

Via e-mail

Unlike Windows 98, Windows 2000 uses a dynamic IRQ management mechanism. Hence, your soundcard will not have a dedicated IRQ. You will have to force Windows 2000 to assign one. Besides, this card consumes two IRQs (one for regular working, and the other for DOS sound blaster emulation). If the problem persists even after manually assigning an IRQ, change the PCI slot. This should solve the problem.

Soundcard set at wrong interrupt address

I have a Pentium 233 MHz with a Creative Vibra128 soundcard and Windows 98 and XP Pro. The soundcard is not recognised by either of the OSs. I downloaded the latest drivers for XP and Windows 98 and installed them. While rebooting the system, I get an error message that the soundcard is set up at the wrong interrupt address, and that I should use automatic settings on the properties page of the soundcard on the Device Manager. It also states 'Audio PCI is disabled'. The interrupt request is set at 11. In the BIOS (Award) IRQ 11 is set as Secondary and configured as PCI/ISA. Changing the interrupt of the soundcard to any number does not help. The system sometimes freezes while working, something that did not happen before installing the drivers.

Sriram Kannan

Via e-mail

CD-not-writing

I recently bought a 24x CD-RW. I have Windows 2000 with SP 2 and the software bundled with the drive was Nero 5.5. I tried installing Easy CD Creator 5 Platinum but while installing, it showed an error saying, 'No compatible drives detected. Do you want to install Direct CD?'

I went ahead with the 'No' option. It did get installed but when I ran it, it showed a message reading 'No suitable recording drives available'. Please advice.

Kuldip

Via e-mail

This problem arises because of an IRQ conflict. Go to your BIOS (press [Delete] while the system is booting up) and assign an IRQ address to the soundcard, which is not being utilised by any other device. Your soundcard should work fine now and your machine will not freeze.

CD-WRITING Burning Errors

I have a Pentium II with 128 MB RAM, a 20 GB hard disk and a 40x CD-ROM drive. I have Windows 98 as my OS. I recently installed a CD-Writer, but I get the following error while writing to the CD:

1. Error reported by output device D0100: I/O error (02/00/001) sense code 0x00
2. T0100: I/O error (06/C5/00) - write error - buffer under run occurred.

Hemandra Badani

Via e-mail

You are getting this error because you have encountered a buffer under run. Apparently, your CD-Writer does not have any buffer under run protection. To avoid getting this error, do not try CD-to-CD copying on the fly. Instead, choose to create an image as offered in

Certain 24x CD-Writers are not detected. In order to detect them, pick up the latest patch available at www.roxio.com.

Applying the patch should solve your problem. However, we strongly recommend you to use the software that is bundled along with your CD-RW—Nero in this case—as manufacturers usually provide you with software that they know is best for their product.



the options. Also reduce the writing speeds to a lower rate and then try copying.

PRINTER

Too long to print

My HP 840C Plus printer takes a long time to start printing. Even the preview takes a long time to show up. I downloaded the latest drivers but that has been of no use. I have a P-III 500 MHz based PC with 128 MB RAM running Windows 98. The printer port is a parallel port.

Ramaswamy

Via e-mail

The preview time may be long because of the file being heavy. However, if a light file such as a text file takes too long to preview then the program you are viewing it in is not correctly installed. Try reinstalling the program. In order to speed up the printing process go to your BIOS (press [Delete] while the system is booting up) and under Communication Port select the Parallel port and configure it as ECP + EPP.

RAM

RAM problems

I am using a Compaq system with 128 MB RAM and a Celeron 433 MHz processor.

I just bought 128 MB of RAM. I removed one stick of 64 MB RAM provided by Compaq and put the new RAM in its place. On starting the computer, it gave an error: 'NTLDR missing' and didn't boot. I have tried putting all three sticks at once and also adjusting the ones provided by Compaq, but it doesn't help.

Madhav

Via e-mail

It is possible that the RAM timings did not match, because of which the OS encountered a page fault causing file corruption and damage to critical OS files. To fix this, first install just the 128 MB RAM module and re-install the OS.

Another cause of the problem could be different RAM specifications although usually asynchronous timings and sizes should not make a difference to the OS with your current configuration, since the memory and the CPU FSB is set to 66 MHz. Nevertheless, depending on the motherboard and the chipset implementation, this can vary and some modules may not work in conjunction with others. Hence, even after reinstalling the RAM if you get the same error,